

SRXEditor User Guide



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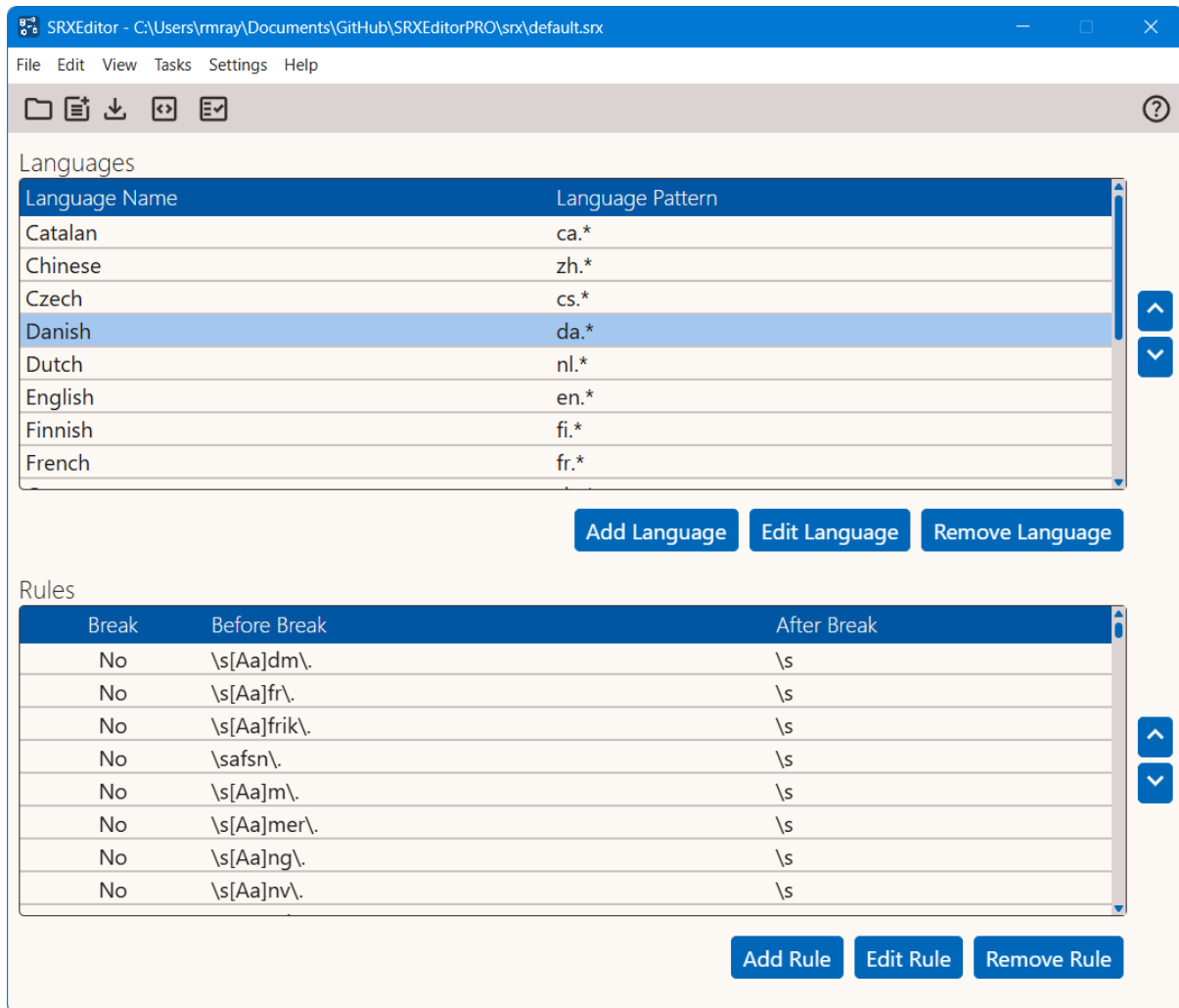
Introduction

SRXEditor

SRXEditor is a cross-platform editor of segmentation rules, designed to use Segmentation Rules eXchange (SRX) 2.0, the open XML-based standard published by LISA.

You can use SRXEditor to create new SRX files or to edit existing ones. It can also be used for testing segmentation rules to ensure that they break text as expected.

SRXEditor User Interface



SRXEditor includes a sample file in SRX 2.0 format with a default set of segmentation rules supporting most standard cases. It also includes segmentation rules specific for these languages:

Catalan	German
Chinese	Italian
Czech	Japanese
Danish	Polish
Dutch	Portuguese

English	Spanish
Finnish	Swedish
French	Thai

Supported Platforms

SRXEditor works on these Operating Systems:

- Microsoft Windows 10 and 11
- macOS Monterey (12.0), Ventura (13.0), Sonoma (14.0), Sequoia (15.0) and Tahoe (26.0)
- Linux for 64-bit x86 (Intel/AMD) processors



NOTICE

SRXEditor installers for Linux are built and tested on Ubuntu 24.04 LTS. The installers are not tested on other distributions.

Basic Concepts

SRX: Segmentation Rules eXchange

Segmentation Rules eXchange (SRX) is the vendor-neutral standard, originally published by LISA (Localization Industry Standards Association), for describing how translation and other language-processing tools segment text for processing.

SRX is an XML vocabulary that allows Translation Memory (TM) and other linguistic tools to describe the language-specific processes by which text is broken into segments (usually sentences or paragraphs) for further processing.

SRX uses regular expressions to indicate the conditions under which a given text needs to be broken or kept as is.

SRX version 2.0 was officially accepted as an OSCAR standard in April 2008.

SRX specification is currently available as HTML page at [Web Archive](#) or in PDF format from [Maxprograms](#).

Regular Expressions

Regular expressions, also known as *patterns*, are formulas that describe text strings using a specially designed syntax.

There are different kinds of regular expressions, usually associated with the programming language that uses them. The most common ones are Perl and Java regular expressions. Although they are very similar, small differences in syntax can lead to very different results when matching text against the same patterns.

SRX (Segmentation Rules eXchange) uses a subset of ICU (Internationalization Components for Unicode) regular expressions. The allowed subset is described in SRX's specification document.

Common Tasks

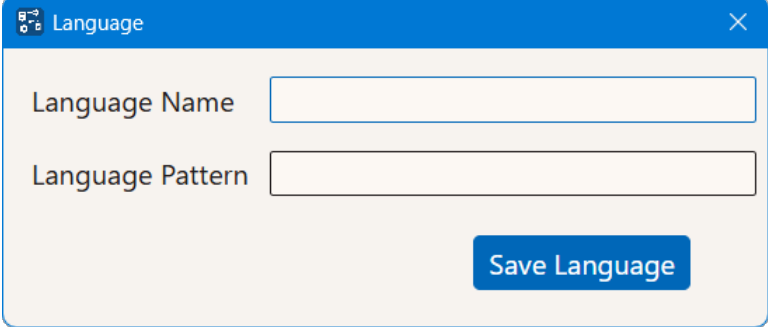
Create SRX File

Create an SRX file that can be used for segmenting documents by translation tools that support SRX 2.0.

Procedure

1. Select **File** → **New File** or click the  button on the toolbar.
2. Click the **Add Language** button.

The **Language** dialog appears:



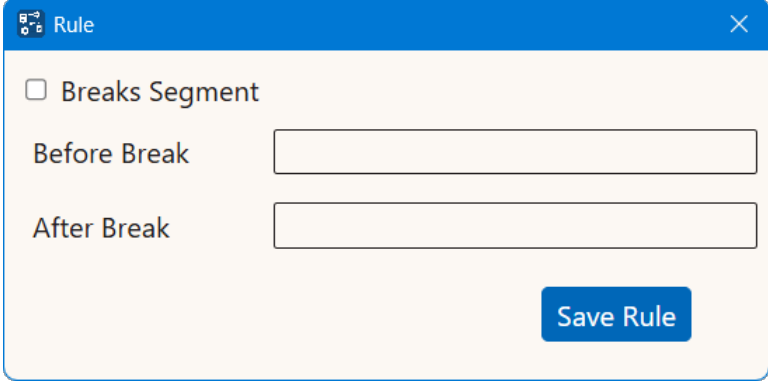
The **Language** dialog box is shown. It has a blue title bar with the text "Language" and a close button (X). The dialog contains two text input fields: "Language Name" and "Language Pattern". Below these fields is a blue button labeled "Save Language".

3. Enter a meaningful name for the language in the **Language Name** text box.
4. Enter a regular expression to indicate the languages supported by the new rule in the **Language Pattern** text box.
5. Click the **Save Language** button.

The new language rule appears in the **Languages** table of the editor.

6. Follow these steps as many times as necessary to populate the language rule with segmentation rules:
 - a. Click the **Add Rule** button.

The **Rule** dialog appears:



The **Rule** dialog box is shown. It has a blue title bar with the text "Rule" and a close button (X). The dialog contains a checkbox labeled "Breaks Segment". Below this checkbox are two text input fields: "Before Break" and "After Break". At the bottom right is a blue button labeled "Save Rule".

- b. Select the **Breaks Segment** check box if the new segmentation rule breaks text. Leave it unselected otherwise.

- c. Enter a regular expression that describes the text that appears before the break point or break exception in the **Before Break** text box.
- d. Enter a regular expression that describes the text that appears after the break point or break exception in the **After Break** text box.
- e. Click the **Save Rule** button.

The new rule appears in the **Rules** table of the editor.

7. Select **File** → **Save File** or click the  button to specify a file name for the SRX file and save it.

Results

A new SRX 2.0 file is generated and saved under the selected name.

Edit Existing SRX File

Modify the content of an existing SRX file to segment text appropriately when using a tool that supports SRX 2.0

Procedure

1. Select **File** → **Open File** or click the  button on the toolbar.
2. Locate and open the SRX file to be modified.
3. To update languages:
 - Click the **Add Language** button to add a new language.
 - In the **Languages** table, select an existing language and click the **Edit Language** button to modify it or click the **Remove Language** button to delete the language and associated rules.

The segmentation rules associated with the selected language rule are displayed in the **Rules** table.

4. To update segmentation rules:
 - Click the **Add Rule** button to add a new segmentation rule.
 - In the **Rules** table, select an existing rule and click the **Edit Rule** button to modify it or click the **Remove Rule** button to delete the selected rule.
5. Select **File** → **Save File** or click the  button to save your changes. Use the **Save File As...** option to save the modified SRX file under a different name.

Results

The selected SRX file is saved with its content updated.

Edit SRX Header

Edit the global settings stored in the SRX header that control how segmentation rules are applied across the entire file.

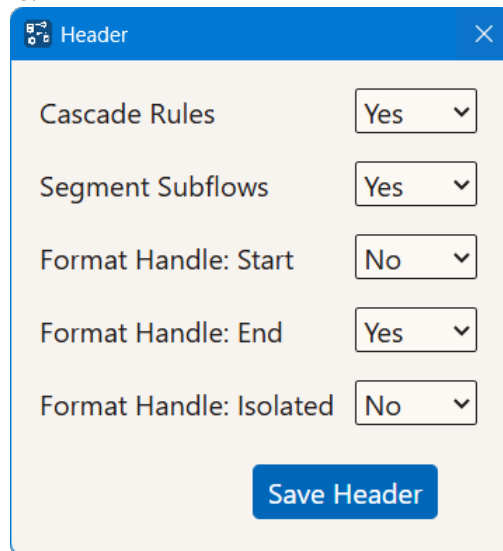
About this task

The SRX header contains document-level attributes that determine cascading behaviour, subflow segmentation, and how inline formatting codes are handled at segment boundaries. These settings apply to all language rules defined in the file.

Procedure

1. Select **File** → **Edit Header** or click the  button on the toolbar.

The **Header** dialog appears:

The image shows a dialog box titled "Header" with a close button (X) in the top right corner. It contains five settings, each with a label and a dropdown menu:

- Cascade Rules: Yes
- Segment Subflows: Yes
- Format Handle: Start: No
- Format Handle: End: Yes
- Format Handle: Isolated: No

At the bottom right of the dialog is a blue button labeled "Save Header".

2. Select **Yes** or **No** in the **Cascade Rules** drop-down list.

When set to **Yes**, the segmentation engine examines all language maps whose pattern matches the source language and accumulates rules from each associated language rule. When set to **No**, accumulation stops after the first matching language map is found.

3. Select **Yes** or **No** in the **Segment Subflows** drop-down list.

A subflow is text embedded inside inline markup that should be treated separately, such as the `@alt` attribute text of an image tag. When set to **Yes**, subflow text is segmented according to the active rules. When set to **No**, subflow text is kept as a single segment regardless of the rules.

4. Select **Yes** or **No** in the **Format Handle: Start** drop-down list.

Controls how an opening inline formatting code (the start of a paired code) is handled when a segment break falls immediately after it. When set to **Yes**, the opening code is included in the segment being closed. When set to **No** (default), the segment is closed before the code, and the code is placed at the start of the following segment.

5. Select **Yes** or **No** in the **Format Handle: End** drop-down list.

Controls how a closing inline formatting code (the end of a paired code) is handled when a segment break falls immediately after it. When set to **Yes** (default), the closing code is included in the segment being closed. When set to **No**, the segment is closed before the code, and the code is placed at the start of the following segment.

6. Select **Yes** or **No** in the **Format Handle: Isolated** drop-down list.

Controls how an isolated inline formatting code (a code with no partner) is handled when a segment break falls immediately after it. When set to **Yes**, the isolated code is included in the segment being closed. When set to **No** (default), the segment is closed before the code, and the code is placed at the start of the following segment.

7. Click the **Save Header** button.

The header settings are updated in the SRX file.

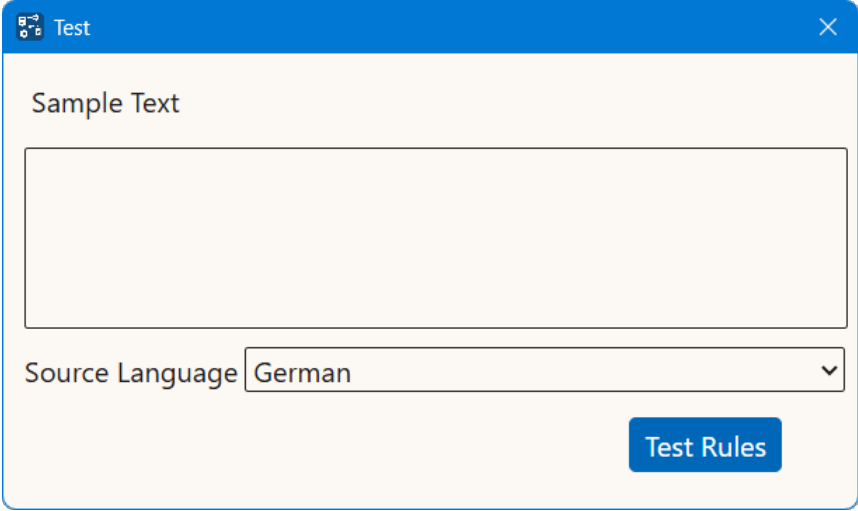
Test Segmentation Rules

Test whether the rules contained in an SRX file can be used to segment text as expected or not.

Procedure

1. Select **Tasks** → **Test Rules** or click the  button from the toolbar.

The following dialog appears:



2. In the **Sample Text** box, type or paste text to segment.
3. Select the language of the sample text in the **Source Language** drop-down list.
4. Click the **Test Rules** button.

Results

An HTML table with the sample text segmented according to the specified rules set is displayed in a new window.

Glossary

Language Rule

A collection of segmentation rules associated with a set of languages defined using a regular expression.

Regular Expression

Formula or expression that describes text strings using a specially defined syntax.

Segmentation Rule

A pair of regular expressions that defines if a given text string has to be broken at segmentation time or if it is an exception that needs to be left untouched.

SRX

Segmentation Rules eXchange (SRX) is an XML-based open standard, originally published by LISA (Localization Industry Standards Association), for describing how translation and other language-processing tools segment text for processing. Although LISA has now disappeared, the SRX standard is still widely in use.